

Forgiveness vs. Reconciliation

40–45 min · February Week 1

OBJECTIVE	Students distinguish forgiveness (an internal psychological process) from reconciliation (the restoration of a relationship), and articulate that forgiveness is never required in situations involving ongoing harm.
CASEL FOCUS	Self-Management: emotional regulation through forgiveness · Relationship Skills: forgiveness vs. reconciliation distinction
SCENARIO CARDS	Forgiveness Card A (The Betrayal) · Forgiveness Card B (The Family Situation — use with caution)
QUICK REVIEW	Skip Quick Review. Begin with the full opening ritual — 2 full minutes. Then deliver the standing statement.

★★ MANDATORY PRE-LESSON REQUIREMENTS

All must be met before class begins. ☐ Counselor is on-site or immediately available (reachable within 60 seconds) for the full lesson ☐ Crisis resources remain visibly posted from U2L6 ☐ No substitute teacher present. This lesson specifically addresses safety in relationships. ☐ Lesson NOT scheduled within 24 hours of a school-wide safety incident or conflict-heavy event

ANCHOR CHART · FORGIVENESS VS. RECONCILIATION — COLOR-CODED T-CHART

Draw **before class**. Color-code the two columns — one color for Forgiveness, a different color for Reconciliation. **FORGIVENESS column:** Internal psychological process. Choosing to release resentment — for your own sake, not theirs. **RECONCILIATION column:** The restoration of a relationship. A separate, external decision. Bold dividing line. Below: "**These are two separate things. You can have one without the other.**" Build the chart slowly **with student input** during Step 1.

OPENING · 2 MINUTES

"Before we begin today, I need to say something clearly that we will come back to throughout this lesson: forgiveness is never required in situations involving ongoing harm. That sentence is the most important thing in today's lesson. Write it down."

Pause. Allow students to write. Then proceed to Step 1.